

Weathered downstream

Soil taken away by weather is washed into rivers and carried out to sea. The soil that took thousands of years to form is lost forever.

It takes 500 years for 2.5 cm (1 in) of soil to form.

Snow can protect grass from freezing temperatures that might damage it.

Frozen solid

Farmers might leave fields unplanted over winter so that crop diseases go away. Cold weather can freeze bare soils in place to stop them being carried away by wind.